



RELOCATION GUIDE

Wellington

Te Whanganui-a-Tara

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Wellington.

Small enough to walk across. Big enough to do tertiary work.

Wellington is a compact, creative capital, and its size is the secret of its charm. A tertiary hospital, a parliament, a national museum, a theatre scene and a working port, all inside a city you can walk across in an afternoon.

~215,000

people in the city,
~440,000 in the region

~900k

tertiary catchment
across two islands

15 min

a typical commute

8 km

across the city at its
widest

IN THIS GUIDE

01 Why clinicians choose Wellington

02 A harbour city ringed by hills

03 Healthcare in Wellington

04 Where to live in Wellington

05 Getting around Wellington

06 What it costs to live here

07 Sophie's insights

08 Food, coffee and culture

09 Weekends in the hills and on the coast

10 Easy trips from Wellington

11 A great city for children

12 Local directory

13 Useful contacts

14 Your Ethicare journey

Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Wellington

The case for the capital comes down to one number: twenty minutes. Everything you can do with the hours that gives back is the real reward.

Wellington sits snugly between the hills and the harbour, so it stayed compact. The city is roughly eight kilometres across at its widest, with a tertiary hospital, a university, the seat of government, a theatre district and a working port all inside it.

The consequence is arithmetic. A thirty-five-minute commute each way is roughly six hours a week. Fifteen minutes each way is two and a half. That difference, most of a working day every week, is the largest lifestyle variable between New Zealand cities, and it compounds over years.



Twenty minutes door to door buys back a working month every year, and the city fills it well.

~6 hrs

a week at 35 minutes each way

~2.5 hrs

a week at 15 minutes each way

3.5 hrs

back, every week
roughly a working month a year



The Beehive: Parliament, in a city small enough to walk across

WHAT YOU GAIN

Same pay, smaller outgoings

Clinical pay sits on national agreements, so your salary matches Auckland's while housing costs meaningfully less.

A walkable life

More people walk to work here than in any other New Zealand city.

A capital's calendar

Theatre, gigs and talks on a Thursday, and a cultural life far larger than the population.

GOOD TO KNOW

The wind

Wellington is famously breezy. Most people stop noticing within a year, and a proper coat does the rest.

Choosing a warm home

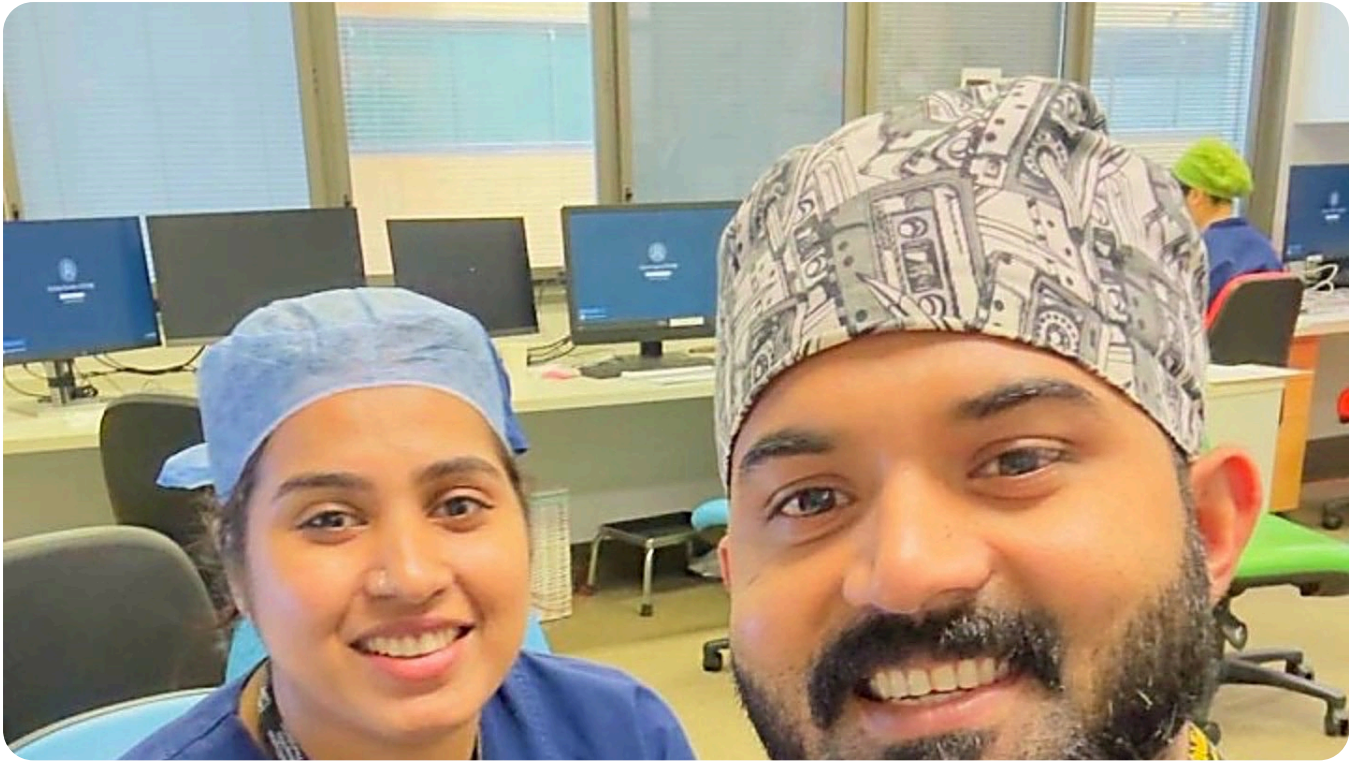
Much of the housing is older timber on hillsides, so sun, insulation and a heat pump are worth putting first. Healthy Homes standards set the minimum.

A close-knit profession

Teams are close-knit, so you are known quickly, and the region's four public hospitals give you options when you are ready for a change.

Flights home

International flights from Wellington go to Australia and the Pacific; long-haul connects through Auckland or Sydney.



Two of the clinicians we have helped move, at work in Wellington

i

Weighing up your options?

Want the largest health system in the country? Auckland. Calmer weather? Hawke's Bay or Nelson Tasman. More house for the money within reach of the capital? Palmerston North, two hours north. We are happy to compare any of them with you.

A harbour city ringed by hills

A harbour in a drowned river valley, ringed by hills, on a plate boundary at the windiest point in the country. The geography explains almost everything about this city.

Steep hills rise straight from the water on three sides, and Cook Strait, a forty-kilometre gap between two mountainous islands, opens to the south. That one arrangement produces the walkable centre, the houses stacked up hillsides with a hundred steps to the door, the four rail lines threading the only flat corridors, and the wind.

A ring of protected bush and open land, the town belt, has encircled the inner city since the 1840s. It is why a capital has native forest fifteen minutes from most front doors.

~10 MIN TO WORK

Wellington City

The compact centre and the hill suburbs around it. Walkable, characterful and the region's most in-demand rentals.

20–40 MIN

The Hutt Valley

Lower and Upper Hutt, by train. Flat land, family houses, gardens, considerably better value, and its own hospital.

~25 MIN

Porirua & the western corridor

North by rail. Diverse, with strong Pacific and Māori communities, and among the best value in the region.

45–60 MIN

Kāpiti Coast

Beaches, a relaxed pace and a genuine commuter rail line, for people who want the coastline on their doorstep.



The hills come down to the harbour, which is why the centre is compact and the suburbs climb

Summer

DEC – FEB

Long evenings and swimming at Oriental Bay. Mild rather than scorching, so a light jumper at a January barbecue is a local habit.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Often the finest weather of the year: settled, warm and calmer. Locals will tell you this is Wellington at its best.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild and rarely freezing, with cosy evenings in from about half past five. A warm, sunny house makes all the difference.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Lively and changeable, with the first long, settled days arriving in October.

The temperature range is narrow: a mean around thirteen degrees, and a good summer day in the low twenties. From northern Europe the winters feel mild; from the Middle East or India, the summers feel cool. The wind is the real story, with gusts above sixty-three kilometres an hour on around 173 days a year.

Wind and earthquakes: easy to prepare for

- ✓ The northerly is warm, blustery and persistent.
- ✓ The southerly comes off Antarctica, drops the temperature within an hour, and can close the airport.
- ✓ You will feel small earthquakes. Building standards are among the strictest anywhere.
- ✓ Sort a grab bag and stored water in week one, then stop thinking about it. That is what locals do.

i

The harbour's Māori heritage

Te Whanganui-a-Tara, the great harbour of Tara. Taranaki Whānui and Ngāti Toa Rangatira are mana whenua of the region, visible in the city's institutions, place names and the way the health service works. You will hear te reo daily. Nobody expects you to arrive fluent; a genuine willingness to learn is what matters.

Healthcare in Wellington

The city is compact, and its tertiary hospital serves the lower North Island and the top of the South. That reach is what makes clinical work here so interesting.

~215k

the city you live in

~440k

the wider region
four public hospitals

~900k

tertiary catchment
the population the
hospital is sized for

The practical effect is a case mix considerably more complex than the population suggests, delivered by closer-knit teams than Auckland's. You get subspecialty exposure with the closeness of a district hospital, a combination many clinicians find ideal.

Patients arrive from the Wairarapa, Whanganui, Palmerston North, Nelson and Blenheim, some by road and some by air. Retrieval and telehealth are routine rather than exceptional, and if that interests you, few places do more of it.



The hospital café in Wellington, seen from the front across the courtyard.

NEWTOWN · 10 MIN FROM THE CBD

The tertiary centre

Intensive care, cardiothoracics, neurosurgery, oncology, a children's hospital and the region's emergency department.

LOWER HUTT · ~25 MIN

A secondary hospital in the valley

Serving the valley, with its own emergency department and a strong reputation for burns and plastics.

PORIRUA · ~25 MIN NORTH

A community hospital

Day surgery, maternity, outpatients and community services for the northern suburbs and western corridor.

OVER THE REMUTAKA HILL

A rural hospital

A wide farming catchment in the Wairarapa: broad generalist work at a very different pace.



The central city, where the national health bodies sit alongside everything else

Beyond the public hospitals, a compact private sector does planned surgery, endoscopy, diagnostics and day procedures. Because everything is close together, a public list in the morning and a private list in the afternoon is a short drive. For theatre nurses, anaesthetic technicians, radiographers and sonographers, private hospitals and community radiology are substantial employers, often with more regular hours.

Being the capital also puts Health New Zealand's national office, the Ministry of Health, Pharmac and Te Aho o Te Kahu in the same city. If policy, quality or research interests you, no other city comes close.

Where to live in Wellington

Bedrooms, schools and the commute matter here too, but three local variables will shape your daily life even more, and they are well worth getting a feel for in person.

Three questions, in this order

- ☐ Which hospital? Everything follows from this. The harbour and hills make some journeys much longer than the map suggests.
- ☐ Car, train or on foot? Car-free means an inner suburb or a rail line, and those are different sets of suburbs.
- ☐ Sun or space? North-facing, sheltered homes are sought after and priced accordingly. South-facing or exposed ones give you more room for the money, with a cooler winter.

INNER SOUTH · WALK TO THE TERTIARY CENTRE

Newtown

The hospital suburb. Villas and flats in the most mixed and lively part of the city, ideal for a car-light life.

INNER EAST · SUNNY, HILLY

Mount Victoria

Character villas on a north-facing slope with harbour views. Sought after, and plenty of steps to keep you fit.

SOUTH COAST & PENINSULA · FLAT

Island Bay & Miramar

Bright, flat family suburbs with beaches. Island Bay takes the southerly; Miramar is among the sunniest parts of the city.

WESTERN SUBURBS · FAMILY

Karori

Large and leafy, with good schools, Zealandia at its edge and bush at the end of most streets. Easiest with a car.

NORTHERN SUBURBS · RAIL

Khandallah & Ngaio

North-facing streets on the Johnsonville line with some of the best winter sun. Ngaio is the peaceful, better-value neighbour.

HUTT VALLEY · FLAT, VALUE

Petone & Lower Hutt

Jackson Street cafés, flat streets, larger sections and the best value within half an hour of the city.

NORTH · COASTAL, DIVERSE

Porirua

Harbour beaches and the region's most affordable family housing. Friendly, diverse and well worth a look.



Timber villas and bungalows: charming, and worth checking for insulation



Suburbs around the bays east of the city, with the airport and Cook Strait beyond

North-facing is the most valuable feature a Wellington house can have: winter sun in the living room, a dry interior and a lower heating bill. Ridge tops and the south coast take the full southerly; a sheltered valley nearby is a different climate. And count the steps: a hundred from the street is charming at a viewing, so picture it after a night shift too.

i

Rent for a year before you commit

Microclimates vary street by street, and a year of renting shows you which side of the hill you love. If you can, view homes on a winter morning to see the sun they really get.

Getting around Wellington

The only New Zealand city where "do I need a car?" has a genuinely interesting answer: four rail lines, a cable car, a harbour ferry and a walkable centre.

Live in an inner suburb or on a rail line and getting to work without a car is straightforward, often faster than driving. But the things people move here for, the south coast in a swell, a trailhead in the Remutakas, Martinborough on a Saturday, mostly need a vehicle. Many households run one car between two adults.

THE MOST WELLINGTON ANSWER

Walking

The CBD is about two kilometres end to end. Locals swear by a proper coat rather than an umbrella.

FOUR LINES

Trains

Hutt Valley, Kāpiti, Johnsonville and Melling lines converge on Wellington Station. The best commuter rail in New Zealand.

METLINK

Buses

The network that reaches up into the hills. Allow a little extra time at peak.

LAMBTON QUAY → KELBURN

The cable car

Commuter infrastructure as well as an attraction: five minutes up the hill.

QUEENS WHARF → DAYS BAY

The harbour ferry

A relaxed, scenic alternative to the drive.

IMPROVING QUICKLY

Cycling

The waterfront route is flat and good; e-bikes have changed what the hills mean.



The flat harbour route into town

i

Getting home after night shifts

Services run late, with fewer after midnight, so for a 3am finish plan on a car, a taxi budget, or a suburb you can walk home from. Sort this early and night rosters are easy.



The airport

10 MIN

One of the most convenient in the country, minutes from town. Long-haul connects through Auckland or Sydney.



The Wairarapa

~1 HR

A scenic drive over the Remutaka Hill road; check conditions on very windy days.



The Interislander to Picton

~3 HRS

One of the great ferry crossings; sailings are occasionally rescheduled in a strong southerly.



Auckland

~8 HRS

Driving it once is part of living here. Most people fly it after that.

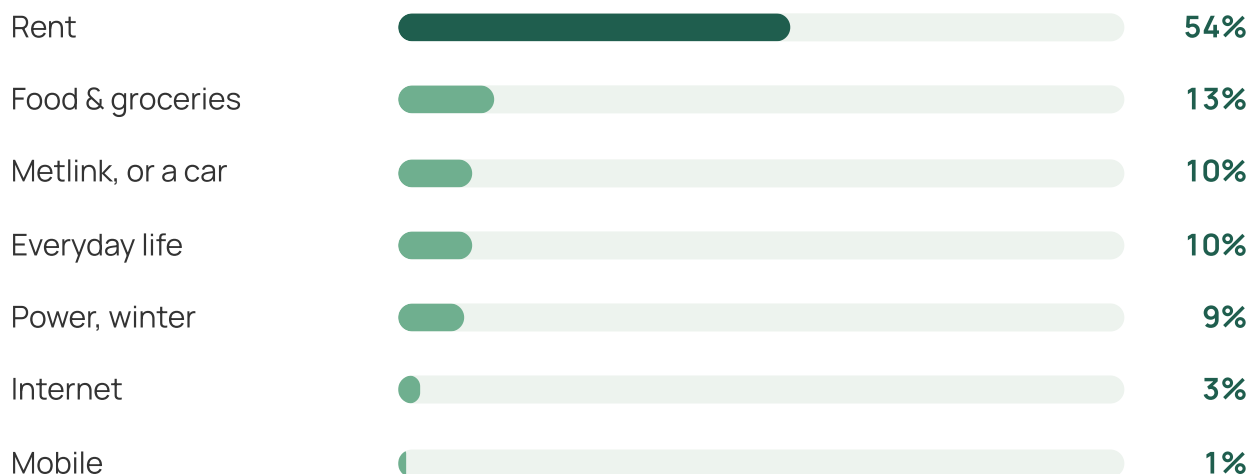
What it costs to live here

Pay is the same as in Auckland and rent is meaningfully lower, with one seasonal bill worth planning for.

Because clinical pay sits on national collective agreements, your gross salary is identical to Auckland's, while housing costs less. That gap is a real financial plus. Inner-suburb rents are higher than in most of the country because a compact city is in demand, and the Hutt Valley and Porirua give you more room for the money.

Where it is cheaper than Auckland: rent, commuting and tolls. Where to plan ahead: winter power, and flights home, which connect through Auckland or Sydney.

Where a month goes



A winter month for a single clinician in an inner suburb. Proportions, not amounts. In summer the power line roughly halves.

Your power bill in July can be two or three times what it was in February. That is what happens when an older timber house meets a cool, damp winter and a heat pump running most of the day. People arriving in summer often sign a lease on a February bill, so budget for the winter figure and treat summer as the discount.

Five ways to keep costs down

- ☐ Prioritise insulation and double glazing above almost every other feature. It is worth more than a second bathroom.
- ☐ Ask for the Healthy Homes compliance statement on any rental.
- ☐ Buy a dehumidifier in your first month. It costs less to run than heating damp air.
- ☐ Compare power retailers properly. Switching is easy, and Powerswitch is the free comparison tool.
- ☐ Heat the room you are in and close the door; it is how most local homes stay cosy.

i

Setting up

Unfurnished usually means unfurnished: often no fridge or washing machine, sometimes no curtains. The bond plus rent in advance is the largest thing to have ready, then whiteware (second-hand from Trade Me is normal), then a dehumidifier and a decent heater, both well worth having.



Some of the best of Wellington is free: a summer swim at Oriental Bay, a short walk from the city



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Wellington

Wellington is the city where people stop feeling new fastest. Within a couple of months you know your barista, your registrar knows your neighbour, and the walk home along the harbour has become the best part of the day.

My practical advice is simple: rent for a year, choose sun over square metres, and buy a proper coat before you land. Do that, and I find most people stop asking whether it was the right move by the first autumn.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Making it official: a first weekend in the capital



A public tour of Parliament, one of the city's free and friendly welcomes

Food, coffee and culture

In the late 1980s a handful of Wellington roasters started taking espresso seriously, and the habit spread to the rest of the country. Today great coffee is on almost every corner.

There are more cafés, bars and restaurants per head than New York, inside a centre you can walk across in twenty minutes. Your morning flat white becomes a small daily pleasure rather than a transaction. Wellingtonians are proud of it, and you will be too within about four months.

THE HEART OF IT

Cuba Street

Independent, bohemian and excellent: bars, cheap eats, live music and the best people-watching in the country.

LOUDER AND LATER

Courtenay Place

Theatres at one end, bars along the length. Where the city goes after a show.

SUMMER EVENINGS

The waterfront

Harbour-edge dining and the walk home along the water.

THE MOST DIVERSE EATING

Newtown

Ethiopian, Malaysian, Middle Eastern, and the grocers that supply them.

SATURDAY MORNING

Hannahs Laneway

A short lane of small producers: chocolate, coffee roasting, cheese.

JACKSON STREET

Petone

Increasingly where the interesting new places open.



Harbour-edge dining on the waterfront at dusk

Three local habits

- ✓ Bring your own cup. It is the local default and usually earns a discount.
- ✓ Know your late-night spots. Many kitchens close fairly early, so find the places that serve late before you finish your first late shift.
- ✓ No tipping. Hospitality staff are paid a proper wage, and tipping is not expected anywhere.
- ✓ Order a flat white, a long black or a short black; "trim" means skim milk, and "takeaway" not "to go".

For the weekly shop, the Harbourside Market by Te Papa on Sunday mornings is the closest thing the city has to a ritual. Newtown and Kilbirnie have specialist grocers for South Asian, Middle Eastern, East Asian and Pacific ingredients. Over the Remutaka Hill, Martinborough's cellar doors are close enough together to cycle between in an afternoon.

Weekends in the hills and on the coast

Bush tracks fifteen minutes from most front doors, a wild coast facing Antarctica, and a predator-free valley in the middle of the city. This is what the short commute is for.

Zealandia is a fenced, predator-free sanctuary in a valley in the middle of Wellington: 225 hectares of regenerating forest. Native birds were reintroduced, then spread out into the city. Kākā now shout from suburban rooftops at dawn, tūi and kererū are everywhere, and it is normal for a neighbour to offer you a rat trap for the garden.

A typical Wellington weekend

- ✓ Sunday morning at the Harbourside Market by Te Papa, then coffee and a walk along the waterfront.
- ✓ Saturday club sport for children and adults, from football and netball to rugby, hockey and swimming.
- ✓ Zealandia, Wellington Zoo or Te Papa with the children, especially when the weather turns.
- ✓ A bush walk in the town belt, up Mount Victoria or through the Botanic Garden, often with kākā overhead.
- ✓ In summer, a swim at Oriental Bay or a ferry across the harbour to Days Bay for fish and chips.
- ✓ Theatre, gigs and festivals through the year, from street parties on Cuba Street to food and arts festivals.



Regenerating bush and swing bridges, minutes from the city

○ The town belt

AN HOUR

Bush tracks from almost any inner suburb. Mount Victoria for the harbour view, the Botanic Garden for the easy version.

○ Red Rocks

HALF A DAY

An hour's walk each way along the south coast, with fur seals hauled out from May to October.

○ Zealandia

HALF A DAY

Ten minutes from town. Guided evening tours to see and hear kiwi in the wild.

○ The Remutakas or the Wairarapa

A DAY

Proper tramping within an hour, or vineyards, Castlepoint and Cape Palliser.

○ The Marlborough Sounds

A WEEKEND

Three hours on the ferry and you are somewhere that feels like a different country.

Wellington has a sheltered harbour side and an exposed southern side, and knowing the difference keeps you safe. The harbour, Oriental Bay and Days Bay, is calm and where families swim. The south coast faces Cook Strait, with strong currents, cold water and surf that arrives fast. Water safety is worth learning early: newcomers are over-represented in New Zealand's drowning statistics.



A sandy Wellington bay on a still day. Check conditions before you swim, every time.

Before your first south-coast swim

- ☐ Swim between the flags where there are any; south-coast patrols run seasonally and only at some beaches.
- ☐ Learn to spot a rip: calmer, darker, flatter water between breaking waves.
- ☐ Caught in one, do not fight it. Float, raise an arm, then swim parallel to shore.
- ☐ Never swim alone on the south coast. Check safeswim.org.nz before you drive out.

“

On the wilder weekends, a capital's museums, theatres and cafés are all minutes from your door.



Pīwakawaka, the fantail: a cheerful companion on bush walks



Fresh produce at a weekend market



The koru, the unfurling fern frond you will spot on every bush track

i

Ideas for a wet or windy day

Te Papa, the national museum, is free and genuinely excellent; locals go repeatedly. Add more theatre and live music per head than anywhere else in the country, and the most Wellington answer of all: a long lunch on Cuba Street.

Easy trips from Wellington

Wellington sits at the southern tip of the North Island, which makes it a gateway in two directions: north to beaches, vineyards and mountains, and south across the strait to the Marlborough Sounds.

Within an hour you can be on the Kāpiti Coast, with long beaches, seaside villages and boat trips to Kāpiti Island, one of the country's most important bird sanctuaries. Over the Remutaka Hill, the Wairarapa offers Martinborough's vineyards, small-town cafés and country markets, and the wild coast at Cape Palliser and Castlepoint.

The Interislander and Bluebridge ferries cross Cook Strait to Picton in about three and a half hours, landing you in the Marlborough Sounds and within reach of Marlborough's vineyards, Nelson and the Abel Tasman. For snow, the ski fields on Mount Ruapehu are about four to four and a half hours north: a long weekend rather than a day trip, but one many Wellington families make every winter.

Palmerston North, two hours north, adds a second regional city with good shopping and the gorge tracks, and the airport ten minutes from the centre puts the rest of New Zealand an hour or so away.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Oriental Bay	about 5 min from the CBD	The city's harbour beach: calm water and sand, and where families swim in summer.
Lyal Bay	~15 min	Surf beach by the airport, with cafés and a lifeguard patrol in summer.
Kāpiti Coast beaches	~45–60 min	Long sandy beaches, villages and boat trips to Kāpiti Island.
Ski fields (Tūroa & Whakapapa, Mt Ruapehu)	~4–4 hrs 30	Ruapehu is the nearest snow, perfect for a long weekend, roughly June to October.
Wellington Airport	about 15 min	Domestic flights across New Zealand; direct international flights to Australia and the Pacific.
Auckland	~1 hr flight · ~8 hrs drive	The country's largest city; most long-haul flights connect here.
Martinborough	~1 hr 15	Vineyards and cellar doors close enough to cycle between, and a pretty village square.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Picton & the Marlborough Sounds	~3 hrs 30 by ferry	A spectacular crossing to sheltered bays, walking tracks and wine country.
~1 HR + BOAT Kāpiti Island A predator-free island reserve off Paraparaumu, with guided day trips and overnight stays to see rare native birds.		~1 HR 15 Martinborough Wine, cafés and long lunches in the Wairarapa, with cycle hire for touring the vineyards.
~2 HRS Cape Palliser The southern tip of the North Island: a lighthouse, a fur seal colony and the Putangirua Pinnacles walk.		~2 HRS 30 Castlepoint A lighthouse on a reef, a sheltered lagoon for paddling and a classic Wairarapa beach weekend.
~45 MIN Remutaka Cycle Trail Old railway tunnels, river valleys and coastal riding, with easy sections for families.		FERRY ~3 HRS 30 Marlborough Sounds Take the car across for a weekend of bays, the Queen Charlotte Track and Marlborough's vineyards.
~4-4 HRS 30 Snow on Ruapehu Lessons, chairlifts and snow play on the North Island's main ski fields. Book accommodation early for school holidays.		



Queen Charlotte Sound in the Marlborough Sounds, a ferry crossing from Wellington



New Zealand fur seals: you can see them along the south coast and at Cape Palliser



Whakapapa, on Mount Ruapehu: a winter weekend in the snow, about four and a half hours north

A great city for children

The city is safe, compact and full of things to do, and schools are strong. Family homes with flat gardens near the centre are in demand, so many families look a little further out.

That is why many families choose the Hutt Valley, Porirua or the flatter suburbs such as Miramar, Island Bay and Karori. Trains, buses and short drives make most of them an easy commute, so weigh garden against travel time to find the balance that suits you.

Children usually start school at five; primary runs Year 1 to Year 8 (often with intermediate schools for Years 7 and 8) and secondary Year 9 to Year 13, across four terms a year.

Most children go to free state schools. Alongside them are state-integrated schools, many Catholic or other church schools, which follow the national curriculum and charge attendance dues, and a number of independent schools. Kura kaupapa Māori and bilingual units offer learning in te reo Māori. Long-established names include Wellington College and Wellington Girls' College, alongside many well-regarded state and integrated schools across the region.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the enrolment zone at the exact address before you sign a lease. Popular state schools run enrolment schemes, and living in zone guarantees a place.
- ☐ Read the school's report from the Education Review Office at ero.govt.nz; ERO reviews every school and early childhood service.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a video call. Principals are used to international families.
- ☐ Ask about support for children new to New Zealand, including English language help.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Zealandia, especially an evening kiwi tour.
- ✓ Wellington Zoo, and Capital E's shows and workshops for young audiences.
- ✓ The harbour beaches in February, when the whole city swims.
- ✓ Swimming at the Wellington Regional Aquatic Centre in Kilbirnie and Freyberg Pool by Oriental Bay.
- ✓ Te Papa, free and built for repeat visits.
- ✓ The cable car up to the Botanic Garden, and the walk back down.
- ✓ Playgrounds on the waterfront and in the Botanic Garden, and Space Place at the Carter Observatory for stargazing.



The cable car, five minutes from Lambton Quay to Kelburn

i

Universities in the city

Victoria University of Wellington is here, and two universities have health campuses in the city, alongside vocational training. Useful if teaching, research or postgraduate study matters to you or a partner.



A family walk along the coast on a bright, breezy day

i

Early childhood

New Zealand funds up to 20 hours a week of early childhood education ("20 Hours ECE") for three to five-year-olds at participating kindergartens and centres. Kindergartens, playcentres, education and care centres and home-based care are all common across the region.



Respect the wind, rent before you buy, and it is the easiest big small city in the country.

Your Wellington address book

Wellington's Indian community has been organised for a century. The Wellington Indian Association dates from 1925, and its Bharat Bhavan in Kilbirnie is still a hub. Kilbirnie and Newtown are where most of the region's South Asian, Middle Eastern and Pacific community life happens. Kerala Catholics have their own Syro-Malabar mission in Paparangi, with Malayalam Qurbana every weekend.

COUNCILS AND SERVICES

Wellington City Council

Rubbish and recycling days by address, pools, parks and holiday programmes

04 499 4444 wellington.govt.nz

Hutt City Council

Lower Hutt and the valley suburbs, if you live up the line
huttcity.govt.nz

Greater Wellington Regional Council

Regional parks, the regional environment and public transport planning

gw.govt.nz

Wellington City Libraries

Library cards, rhymetime and free events across the city's branches

wcl.govt.nz

GETTING AROUND

Metlink

Buses, trains and harbour ferry across the region, with live times and the Snapper card

metlink.org.nz

Safeswim

Water quality and swim conditions at Wellington beaches

safeswim.org.nz

GETTING TO KNOW THE PLACE

WellingtonNZ

The region's official visitor and events site
wellingtonnz.com

Te Papa

The national museum on the waterfront, free to enter
tepapa.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Wellington Indian Association

Indian community association since 1925, based at Bharat Bhavan, 48 Kemp Street, Kilbirnie; festivals (including Navratri), Gujarati classes, seniors' and fitness groups.

wia.org.nz

Wellington Mutamizh Sangam

Tamil association: Saturday Tamil school in Newlands, a badminton club in Tawa, and cultural events.

wellingtonmutamizhsangam.org.nz

Multicultural Council of Wellington

Umbrella body bringing together more than 30 ethnic communities across the region; a good first call for finding your community group.

English Language Partners – Wellington

Free and low-cost English classes, conversation groups and home tutoring. Level 5, 186 Willis Street, Te Aro.

04 384 1992

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/wellington

English Language Partners – Lower Hutt

English classes and conversation groups for Hutt Valley residents, 27 Kings Crescent.

04 570 1335

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/lower-hutt

English Language Partners – Porirua

English classes and conversation groups, Level 1, 7 Hartham Place South.

04 238 9400

englishlanguage.org.nz/centres/porirua

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential advice for anyone on tenancy, work, money and services; branches across the region.

cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Government community directory and support for migrant communities, headquartered in Wellington.

ethniccommunities.govt.nz

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Mary's Syro-Malabar Mission Wellington

Kerala Catholic mission at 27 Trebann Street, Paparangi: Malayalam Holy Qurbana on Saturday and Sunday, catechism and youth (SMYM).

smmissionwellington.org.nz

Catholic Archdiocese of Wellington

Find a Catholic parish and Mass times anywhere in the region.

wn.catholic.org.nz

Gita Mandir, Bharat Bhavan

Hindu temple inside the Wellington Indian Association centre, 48 Kemp Street, Kilbirnie; open daily.

wia.org.nz

Sri Venkateswara Swamy Temple of Wellington

South Indian Hindu temple at 25 Waiu Street, Wainuiomata, Lower Hutt; open weekday evenings and weekends, with a full festival calendar.

svwt.org.nz

Wellington mosque (Kilbirnie)

Main mosque and Islamic centre at 7–11 Queens Drive, Kilbirnie, also the national FIANZ office; prayer timetables and community welfare.

04 387 8023 fianz.com

Wellington Jewish Community Centre

Hub for Jewish life in Wellington: programmes, events and help with finding a congregation and kosher supplies.

wjcc.org.nz

Anglican Church in Aotearoa

Find an Anglican parish near you.

anglican.org.nz

Presbyterian Church of Aotearoa NZ

Find a Presbyterian congregation near you.

presbyterian.org.nz

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Sun2moon Indian Grocery Store

Indian grocer in the central city, 189 Willis Street, Te Aro.

04 381 3143

Spice Mart, Johnsonville

Indian grocer at 8 Burgess Road, Johnsonville, handy for the northern suburbs.

04 477 9442

Yogiji's Food Mart, Petone

Large Indian grocery at 56 Hutt Road, Petone.

04 568 3030

Indian Fiji Mini Mart, Upper Hutt

Indian and Fijian groceries at 4 Russell Street, Upper Hutt.

04 528 6518

Oriental Pantry

Asian supermarket group serving the Wellington region.

04 213 8962

U.K Goodies, Petone

British groceries and treats, 327 Jackson Street, Petone.

04 589 4386

Kilbirnie and Newtown

Many South Asian, Middle Eastern, East Asian and Pacific grocers and halal butchers; the mosque community can point you to current halal butchers.

FIANZ halal certification list

National list of halal-certified NZ brands, useful for supermarket shopping.

fianz.com

Kosher supplies

Ask the Wellington Jewish Community Centre; there is a wider range in Auckland and online.

wjcc.org.nz

NZ Uniforms

Uniform stores in Wellington, Lower Hutt and Porirua; also check the school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales.

nzuniforms.com/pages/store-locator.htm

Plunket

Free parenting support and checks for under-5s; PlunketLine on 0800 933 922.

plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood groups across the region.

playcentre.org.nz

Wellington City Libraries

Branches across the city, with children's sessions, ethnic community programmes and free Wi-Fi.

04 801 4040 wcl.govt.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

PAK'nSAVE, New World, Woolworths, FreshChoice, Four Square

All the main chains are across the region; use each chain's store finder for your suburb.

paknsave.co.nz

Harbourside Market

Every Sunday, 7.30am to 2pm, corner of Cable and Barnett Streets beside Te Papa: fresh produce and food stalls; closed Christmas Day, New Year's Day and Anzac Day.

wellington.govt.nz/news-and-events/events-and-festivals/harbourside-market

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Find a school / school zones

Check which state schools are zoned for an exact address.

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property – Wellington

Main rental and sale listings site.

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/wellington

realestate.co.nz

Sale and rental listings from local agencies.

realestate.co.nz

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check what rents in a suburb actually go for before you offer.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Wellington City Council property search

Rates and property information for any Wellington city address.

wellington.govt.nz/property-rates-and-building/property/property-search

Trade Me Flatmates

Rooms and flatshares while you find a house.

trademe.co.nz/a/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

Metlink

Buses, trains and harbour ferries across the Wellington region, with a journey planner and live times.

[metlink.org.nz](https://www.metlink.org.nz)

Snapper card

The tap-on fare card for Metlink buses; check Metlink for current train and ferry payment options.

[snapper.co.nz](https://www.snapper.co.nz)

Wellington Airport

Domestic flights and short-haul flights to Australia, 15 minutes from the CBD.

[wellingtonairport.co.nz](https://www.wellingtonairport.co.nz)

Interislander

Ferry to Picton for the South Island, with cars carried.

[interislander.co.nz](https://www.interislander.co.nz)

Bluebridge

The other Cook Strait ferry to Picton.

[bluebridge.co.nz](https://www.bluebridge.co.nz)

InterCity

Long-distance coaches north to Palmerston North, Napier and Auckland.

[intercity.co.nz](https://www.intercity.co.nz)

NZTA driver licences

Converting an overseas licence and finding a licensing agent.

[nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences](https://www.nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences)

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo – Wellington

Crowd-sourced prices to compare with your current city.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Wellington

Expatistan – Wellington

Second crowd-sourced comparison.

expatistan.com/cost-of-living/wellington

Tenancy Services market rent

Official recent rents by suburb and house size.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Powerswitch

Free comparison of power plans; this matters for Wellington's winter bills.

[powerswitch.org.nz](https://www.powerswitch.org.nz)

Sorted budget planner

Free government-backed budgeting tools.

[sorted.org.nz](https://www.sorted.org.nz)

Stats NZ

Official price, rent and wage statistics.

[stats.govt.nz](https://www.stats.govt.nz)



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

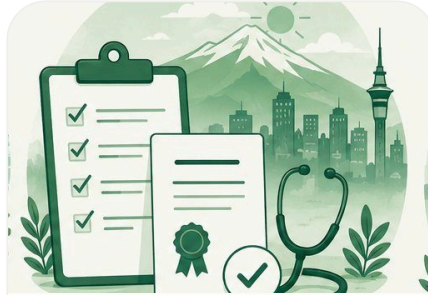
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

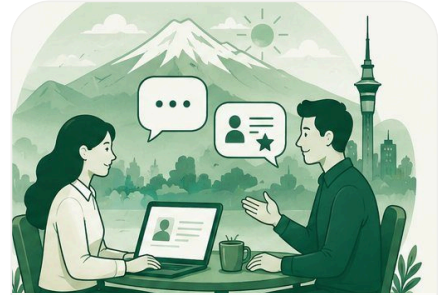
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Wellington. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

hello@ethicareresourcing.com · +44 7375 019544 · ethicareresourcing.com

One Coldbath Square, London EC1R 5HL · Company No. 14646354